



Richmond, Virginia's Housing Crisis

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Summary of Richmond

Population



Richmond holds over **229,247** residents

Government



Richmond operates under a Mayor-Council form of government.

Income Distribution



Median income is **\$62,671** and for an individual it was just below **\$35,000**. The income per capita is **\$44,249**.

Size



62-square-mile area

Population Growth



In 2010, population was **204,375**. It has **grown 12.2%** in the last 10 years. In comparison to the US (7.7%) and Virginia (8.2%)

Density



The population density ~ **3700 people per square mile**. **Fifth** most populous city Metro area is the **third** most populous in Virginia

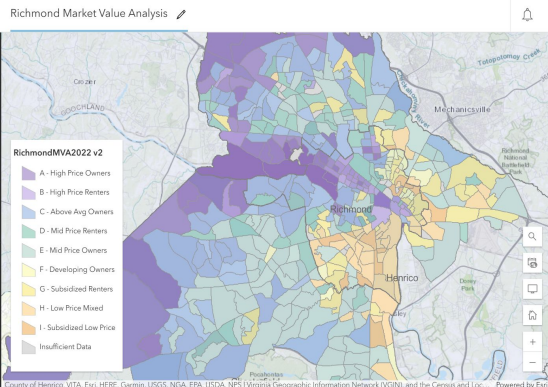
Introducing the Issue



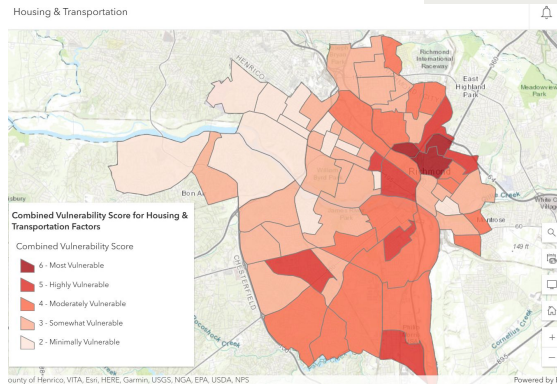
Housing Landscape

Who It Affects

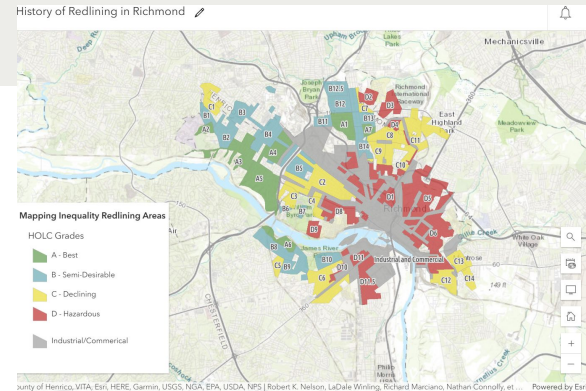
Potential Cause



- **One in five** homes sold to out-of-state investors.
- **Investor-dominated** areas have higher rental instability and displacement risk.
- Home prices have surged by **52.6%** in 5 years, with a median sale price of \$316,000, making homeownership increasingly inaccessible.



- Many young adults, essential workers, and low-income families live in **overcrowded** or **substandard** housing, lacking **A/C**, **internet**, or **stable utilities**.
- **High rent burdens** upwards of **30%** are spent on housing leave little for essentials like food, healthcare, and schooling.



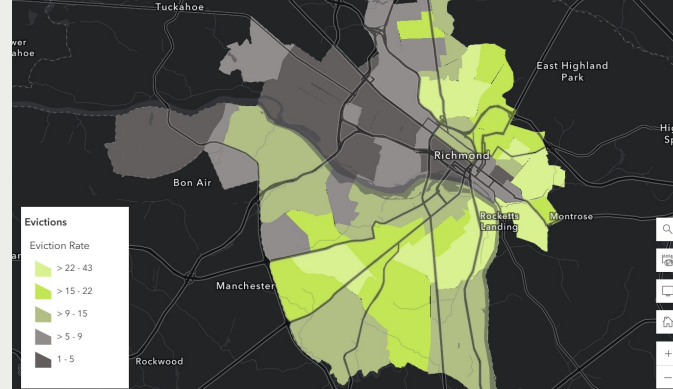
- **Historical housing discrimination** shaped today's affordability crisis, with **redlined areas** still facing lower homeownership and higher poverty.
- Many **previously redlined** neighborhoods align with modern displacement risk and eviction hotspots, showing the **long-term effects of systemic disinvestment**.

Policy Intervention

Incentives for local homeownership **+** Limits on investor-driven property purchases

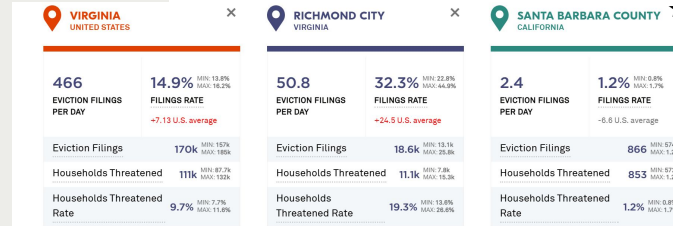
= Mitigating negative impacts of gentrification

- Implement affordable housing initiatives in the areas that have the most severe housing shortages
- Incentivize the construction of affordable housing through grants offered to developers
- Expanding rental assistance programs to low-income families will offer them financial support and decrease the risk of eviction
- Implementing rent control measures for renters facing unaffordable housing can stabilize housing costs

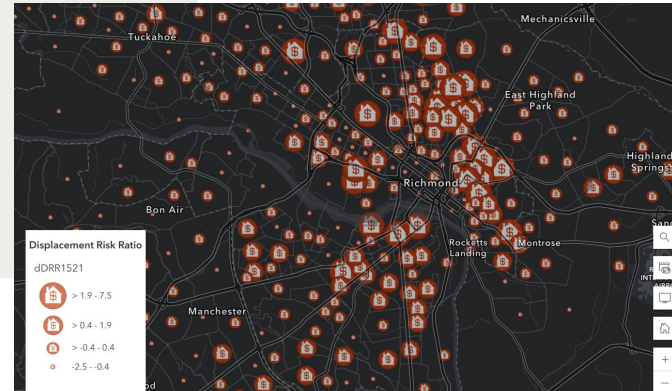


Eviction Rate Map

- Pinpoints eviction hotspots where residents face **immediate housing instability**.
- Reinforces the need for stronger tenant protections, rent stabilization, and **eviction prevention** programs



Richmond's **eviction filing** and **household threatened rates** are significantly higher than VA and SB, highlighting Richmond's worsening affordability crisis and the need for **targeted housing interventions**.



Displacement Risk Ratio Map

- Shows where **home prices are rising faster than incomes**, making displacement more likely.
- Clearly identifies neighborhoods that most urgently need affordable housing protections and **renter assistance**.

Potential Unintended Consequences



- **Risk of Gentrification & Displacement** → Rising property values may push out long-term residents instead of helping them.
- **Infrastructure Strain** → Increased housing density could overwhelm schools, transit, and public services without proper investment.
- **Investor Pushback** → Limits on investor ownership may reduce housing availability and discourage new development.
- **Funding & Sustainability** → Affordable housing programs require long-term funding, which may be difficult to maintain.

Potential Benefits



- **Stabilizes Housing Costs** → Increases supply and limits investor-driven rent hikes.
- **Reduces Displacement Risk** → Expands affordable housing in high-need areas.
- **Increases Housing Availability** → Supports low- and middle-income residents.
- **Aligns with the Rosen-Roback model** → Ensures affordability supports economic growth.
- **Addresses cost-income gap** → Tackles rising housing costs outpacing wage growth.
- **Boosts Overall economy** → Attracts new residents and strengthens local businesses.

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